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Democracy Dies in Darkness

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Plan to feed Gaza faced questions from start

Documents show group anticipated concerns on morality, qualifications

BY GERRY SHIH,
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JERUSALEM — Last year, a group of former U.S. intelligence and defense officials and business executives, working in close consultation with Israel, prepared a proposal for supplying humanitarian aid to Gaza that would address Israeli government claims that assistance was being diverted by Hamas.

In previously unreported internal documents, the group detailed a radically new and ambitious model: It envisioned the creation of an organization called the Gaza Humanitarian Foundation (GHF) that would hire armed private contractors to provide logistics and security for a handful of aid distribution hubs to be built in southern Gaza.

Under the arrangement, which would replace existing aid distribution networks coordinated by the United Nations, Palestinian civilians would have to travel to the hubs and submit to identity checks to receive rations from nongovernmental organizations (NGOs). Eventually, according to the plan, Palestinians would live in guarded compounds that would each house up to tens of thousands of noncombatants.

But as early as November, the documents showed, the planners anticipated that the foundation could face potentially damaging questions from the public about its opaque origins, qualifications and moral legitimacy. Those

SEE GAZA ON A14

In Syria: Trump eases sanctions, as pledged, to aid war-torn nation. **A13**

Trump's tariffs cloud future of this high-end medical marvel

BY KATE BRADY,
DANIEL GILBERT
AND WILLIAM BOOTH

FORCHHEIM, GERMANY — On the outskirts of this bucolic town, in a region known as “das Medical Valley,” workers on a vast factory floor are assembling what they describe as the future: the game-changing scanners that can give doctors the most detailed images ever of what is happening inside the hearts, lungs and brains of their patients.

One of the scanners, two decades in the making and called the “Naeotom Alpha,” is unique, say its inventors at Siemens Healthineers, a global leader in CT technology. “The image quality is incomparable,” boasts Jesús Fernández, head of CT product marketing at the company, comparing the device’s technological leap to the difference between a 1970s television set and HDTV.

Since the scanners started shipping four years ago, leading hospitals around the world have ordered them. The Food and Drug Administration called the Naeotom Alpha — after approving its use — “the first major new technology for computed tomography imaging in nearly a decade.” Forty percent of the scanners are exported to the U.S. market.

SEE TARIFFS ON A11



DANIELE VOLPE/FOR THE WASHINGTON POST

A childhood under gangs' shadow

The gang name was scrawled onto classroom desks and written on bathroom walls. At the school where Kilmar Abrego García spent most of his adolescence, the students all knew who was in charge of the neighborhood: MS-13.

It was a prime age for gang recruitment. A Salvadoran boy who was old enough to speak into a cellphone was old enough to work for a gang. Before their voices had even changed, the students knew who among them had joined.

Abrego García was not one of them, his teachers and a classmate said. During his years at the school — between about 2003 and 2011 — Abrego García consistently demonstrated “very good conduct,” according to official school records provided to The Washington Post.

But toward the end of his time at the school, his friends began to worry he might be having problems at home. “He seemed sad, like his mind was on something else,” said a former classmate, who spoke on the condition of anonymity out of security concerns.

There were gang threats to him and his family, Abrego García would later say in court.

Fearing for his safety, at 16 years old, he fled to the United States.

Fourteen years later, Abrego García has found himself back in his home country, less than two hours from his former school, deport-

ed to a Salvadoran prison because of a self-described “administrative error” by the Trump administration. He was one of about 260 migrants deported to El Salvador in March and put in a maximum-security mega prison. His case is now at the center of one of the Trump administration’s biggest court fights.

BY SAMANTHA SCHMIDT
IN SAN SALVADOR



OBTAINED BY THE WASHINGTON POST

Kilmar Abrego García fled to the U.S. at 16, his age in the above 2011 photo. TOP: The Los Nogales neighborhood where Abrego García lived.

Neither government has shown any willingness to return him to the United States, despite the U.S. Supreme Court ruling that the Trump administration must facilitate Abrego García’s return. A Maryland federal judge repeatedly expressed frustration over a lack of information on any steps the U.S. government has taken to comply with those court orders. A separate federal judge in Washington gave the Trump administration until Friday to identify its efforts to return Abrego García and the other migrants who were deported with him.

This weekend, Rep. Glenn Ivey (D-Maryland) plans to travel to El Salvador to ask for information about Abrego García’s case and the others deported to the country’s prison system. El Salvador’s increasingly authoritarian president, Nayib Bukele, in an Oval Office meeting with President Donald Trump, said “of

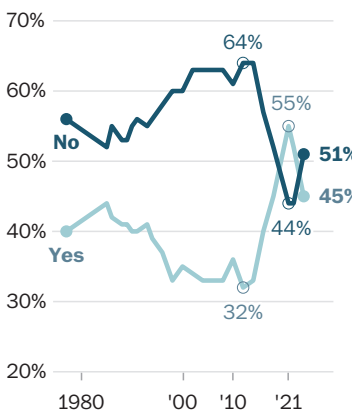
SEE ABREGO GARCÍA ON A18

Courthouse arrests: ICE rolls out a new tactic to dramatically accelerate deportations. **A2**

Five years after Floyd's murder, racial reckoning has stalled

In 2024, fewer Americans blamed discrimination for economic gaps between Black and White people

Q: On the average Black people have worse jobs, income and housing than White people. Do you think these differences are mainly due to discrimination?



Note: “Don’t know” not shown.

Source: General Social Survey conducted by NORC at the University of Chicago. In 2024, question was asked of 1,016 U.S. adults with an error margin of +/- 4.3 points.

SCOTT CLEMENT/THE WASHINGTON POST



LUCY BAPTISTE/REUTERS

Danielle Miller places a rose on the memorial for George Floyd in Minneapolis on Friday ahead of the fifth anniversary of his murder by city police officers.

BY AKILAH JOHNSON
AND SCOTT CLEMENT

It’s been five years since George Floyd’s murder by Minnesota police officers — nine minutes and 29 seconds captured on video and broadcast around the globe, an inflection point in America’s centuries-old struggle with racism.

Floyd’s death ushered in what many called a “racial reckoning.” Much of the national conversation on race curved toward police reform, health equity and the racial wealth gap.

But that momentum has largely stalled as the country reaches another inflection point in scrutinizing its racial dynamics, according to political scientists and public policy experts. Corporations have withdrawn from billion-dollar promises to address racial inequality. Public support for sweeping police reform and the Black Lives Matter movement has plummeted. Hours into his second term, President Donald Trump started a campaign to dismantle

SEE FLOYD ON A8

West Point: Trump addresses institution upended by changes. **A7**

METRO

A mission for peace was dealt a blow by gunfire at Jewish museum in D.C.

SPORTS

By dancing together, two women shattered a figure skating taboo.



BOOK WORLD

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BUSINESS

Clothes menders are remaking ideas about fashion, stitch by stitch.



ARTS & STYLE

Jennifer Hudson’s crew turns a hallway into a venue with viral impact.

TRAVEL

We tried Jennifer Aniston’s travel workout. Did we get A-list arms?

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